

Why People Fall out of Prayer

Let us look at Romans 12 again as we enter into this next phase.

Romans 12 says:

I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that you present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable unto God, which is your reasonable service.

And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind, that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God.

Of course, the word "therefore" means, "Based on what I have already said, I am about to say this." So what he is about to say to us in Romans 12 is based on something he has already said.

Then Paul goes on:

For I say, through the grace given unto me, to every man that is among you, not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think; but to think soberly, according as God hath dealt to every man the measure of faith.

For as we have many members in one body, and all members have not the same office:

So we, being many, are one body in Christ, and every one members one of another.

Having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us...

Is he not talking about a many-membered body called the Body of Christ, of which you and I are individual members in particular? He says we all have grace differing according to the measure of faith, or according to the grace God has separated us to.

In other words, I hold the office I hold in this many-membered Body called the Body of Christ. You hold the office you hold, and another holds the calling he holds, not by his own choice, but by the grace differing according to God's measure or His call upon our lives.

I did not place myself in this office. That is why Paul said we ought not to think of ourselves more highly than we ought, but to think soberly, according as God has dealt to every man the measure of faith.

Somehow, by offering myself as a living sacrifice, I enter into a process that results in not being conformed to this world, but being transformed to find not only the good and the acceptable, but the absolute perfect will of God for my personal life.

The good, acceptable, and perfect will of God is not just revelation knowledge of His Word. It is also the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God for your individual life, as a member in the Body of Christ, with a grace that differs according to the measure of faith delivered to you.

Your call is different from mine. But somehow, offering your body as a living sacrifice results in finding the absolute perfect will of God for your personal life.

When God began to open this chapter to me, my prayer was not that I was afraid of what He meant by offering my body as a living sacrifice. All I wanted to know was how to do it. If offering my body as a living sacrifice resulted in finding the absolute perfect will of God for my life in the Body of Christ, then the question was not whether I would do it. The question before God was, "Please tell me how."

It was not until that word "therefore" opened up to me that I understood how. "I beseech you therefore" means Paul had already given us the information in the previous chapters. So when I saw that word, I went back into the previous chapters to find out how to offer my body.

I found out that offering my body the way some holiness people had taught me did not do any good.

Through extreme discipline, I quit smoking. I quit chewing. I quit going with the girls who did. I dressed the way they wanted me to dress. I took the jewelry off. I got rid of the television. I did everything they wanted me to do because they told me that was offering myself as a living sacrifice.

Let me tell you something about the works of the flesh: once you begin that program of self-mortification through extreme discipline, there is nowhere to stop. Just as soon as you put something off, the devil comes along and condemns you about something else.

There is no place to stop. Finally you will end up in a monastery somewhere, dressed in a spiked girdle and a hairy shirt, sleeping sitting up, unable to speak to anybody because you took a vow of silence.

In that kind of holiness, you can deny your flesh all the way down the line until there is nothing left. Then you have to go a step further into asceticism. When self-denial is not enough, you go further and torture the flesh. Cut your fingers off. Crawl on your belly over glass. Sleep sitting up. Never talk to anybody again as long as you live.

When you get into programs of the flesh, there is absolutely nowhere to stop. You cannot make yourself good enough. I do not care what you deny yourself. You cannot make yourself good enough.

So if there was a way to offer my body as a living sacrifice according to God's plan, I wanted to know how.

I dug into the previous chapters and found out that Romans 8 held the key. Then, by golly, if it was not the same key Jude gave me.

Jude says you do not have to be sense-ruled. You can build yourself up above that mess by praying in the Holy Ghost.

Romans 8 says your weakness is in the flesh because you do not know how to pray as you ought. The Holy Spirit steps in and makes intercession for you with groanings which cannot be uttered. He deals with the weaknesses and the mortification of the flesh.

He that searches the heart knows what is the mind of the Spirit, the plan of God, and He can successfully make intercession for you according to the will of God.

So when we offer ourselves as living sacrifices, we are offering ourselves to the Holy Spirit. He is the One who can turn us over to the death of the flesh and work two things in us.

First, He works the revelation knowledge of His Word in our spirits. Second, He supernaturally works the plan of God on the inside of our hearts. That, my friend, is true mortification.

Paul made this statement: God has dealt to every man the measure of faith.

I would be the last one to call God a liar. If He said He has given you a measure of faith and He has given me one, then I possess a measure of faith. A measure is part of a whole. These measures are the different offices in the Body of Christ. Each possesses its own measure, but all these measures working together make one complete, devil-stomping, mountain-moving Body of Christ.

I only possess one of those measures. You only possess one of those measures. Yet God has instilled into every born-again man's spirit the measure of faith. Contained within that measure is enough faith to appropriate everything the Cross says you are: your healing, your blessings, your ministry, your call, all of it.

For you to stand in God's presence and say, "I do not have enough faith," is to call God a liar, because He delivered to you the measure to fulfill your ministry and to appropriate everything the Cross redeemed for you.

Someone says, "Well, I would have gone to Mexico last year if I had enough money."

Did He tell you to go? Suppose you stand before Jesus and ask, "Was I supposed to go that year?"

He says, "Yes, you were."

"Then why did the money not come in? Why did You not give me the money?"

He says, "I sent it, but you did not receive it."

The money did not come in. Are you saying you did not have enough faith? He gave you the measure of faith to fulfill your call and appropriate everything the Cross has for you.

But that measure comes in the form of a seed. It is deposited on the inside of your spirit when you are born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the Word of God.

Your seed is different from my seed. A corn seed produces a corn stalk. A wheat seed produces a wheat stalk. A cantaloupe seed produces a cantaloupe. The diagramming and programming on the inside of my seed is different from the diagramming and programming on the inside of your seed.

Yet when each of us begins to pray in the Holy Ghost, Jesus said:

He that believeth on me, as the scripture hath said, out of his belly shall flow rivers of living water.

Out of your innermost being, your spirit, will flow rivers of living water. And guess what? You cannot spend an hour praying in the Holy Ghost without throwing water on that seed.

On the inside of that seed is the diagramming and programming for your entire life, your entire ministry, every branch, every facet, every harvest. You cannot come on Wednesday night and pray hour after hour without that seed beginning to germinate. The stalk will come out. The limbs will start shooting. Leaves will start collecting. Pretty soon your first harvest will come.

That direction will become so set on the inside of your spirit that someone will ask, "How do you know that is your call?"

My friend, what do you think? When that incorruptible seed begins to sprout and produce, it contains not only the understanding of faith, but also the diagramming and programming for your call and what is to unfold in your life.

Once again, this comes forth in two phases.

First, there is transformation to His Word. "Be not conformed to this world, but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind."

Think of a transformer on a telephone pole. The voltage comes in at one degree and goes out at another. The Word of God comes into you at one velocity, one voltage, and it transforms your life and comes out at another.

Paul is talking about something supernatural happening to you as you are transformed, not conformed to this world, but transformed by the renewing of your mind, so that you prove the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God.

The Holy Ghost works in those two areas. First, the Word comes alive and transformation begins to take place. Second, He plants His call in your life and that also begins to unfold.

If transformation takes place from offering your body as a living sacrifice, and praying in tongues is one of the keys to offering my body, then let us look more closely at what happens when we stand before God and say, "Father, I am going to turn myself over to the Holy Spirit for the next couple of hours for the purpose of offering my body as a living sacrifice."

What begins to take place? What is happening when you stand, sit, or lie there praying those two hours? What is really transpiring in the world of the Spirit?

In the Old Testament, a living sacrifice started out living and ended up dead. It gave itself all the way to death. God does not want us physically dead. He wants us as a living sacrifice. But He wants us dead to the things of the world and alive unto Him.

Therefore, you cannot pray two hours in the Holy Ghost without Him attempting to turn a little more of your life over as a living sacrifice so that you will be more dead to the world and more alive to God.

Why two hours? Because that is how long we pray on Wednesday night.

You cannot pray five minutes in the Holy Ghost without Him attempting to turn a little bit of your life over as a living sacrifice. Much less can a bunch of you get absolutely fanatical about it and spend hours on Wednesday night without Him beginning the mortification process.

Someone says, "Brother Roberson, those two hours on Wednesday night are my shortest prayer time."

It may be that you spend hours a day beyond those two hours in here. But you cannot do it without Him somehow beginning the process of offering your body as a living sacrifice, resulting in the creation and finding of His absolute perfect will for your life.

How on God's green earth does this take place?

We have an interesting note in Isaiah 28:

Whom shall he teach knowledge? and whom shall he make to understand doctrine?

Them that are weaned from the milk, and drawn from the breasts.

For precept must be upon precept, precept upon precept; line upon line, line upon line; here a little, and there a little:

For with stammering lips and another tongue will he speak to this people.

To whom he said, This is the rest wherewith ye may cause the weary to rest; and this is the refreshing.

He asks a question: Whom shall He teach knowledge? Whom shall He make to understand doctrine? Then He tells you who: those who are weaned from milk and drawn from the breast.

Strong meat belongs to those who by reason of use have their senses exercised to discern both good and evil. That means through the use of the strong meat of the Word, they bring their systems, imaginations, and senses under obedience to the Word and put them through an exercise.

The man who is on milk is unskillful in the word of righteousness, for he is a baby. To be quite frank, he does not know how to use the Word. He may understand that healing is in the Word of God and belongs to him. He may know prosperity belongs to him. He may know the Word says it does. But he cannot get the disease off his body because he is unskillful in the use of the Word of God.

So who can receive this kind of teaching, line upon line, precept upon precept? He says it is those who, through stammering lips and another tongue, receive that supernatural manifestation and gift of the Holy Spirit. He says this is the rest. This is the refreshing. Hereby He causes the weary to rest.

I know that when I pray in tongues, I am speaking mysteries before the Father. Because I am speaking these mysteries before the Father, He can pull me aside and teach me line upon line, here a little and there a little, precept upon precept. He can wean me from milk onto strong meat because transformation is now taking place through the power of the Holy Spirit instead of through men.

But did you notice He said, "This is the rest. This is the refreshing. Hereby you may cause the weary to rest"?

Are you tired? Are you weary? Some of you need rest in your souls.

You cannot pray two hours in the Holy Ghost without actively offering your body as a living sacrifice. That means some kind of death process is involved. It is impossible to grow in God without leaving the world behind.

When line upon line and precept upon precept begins, this weaning from the breast begins. And what accompanies it is this rest and this refreshing.

When I was born again, I entered the Kingdom of God, created after God in righteousness and true holiness. But my outer man had not yet conformed to the inner man. I entered the Kingdom with boatloads of problems.

I started praying in the Holy Ghost, and He started purging me from things that were keeping me from rest. It was not until two or three years ago that the final things in my life began to die, and God did for me personally what I did not dream possible. He ushered me into a peace.

If you were to ask me, apart from receiving the baptism of the Holy Spirit, "What is the most powerful thing you have received from the Lord Jesus Christ?" I would have to say that incredible peace He brought me into. Nothing has ever come into my life that made me more unmanageable by the devil.

The devil comes and threatens with everything under the sun, but I have so much peace in my spirit that it makes me unmanageable by him.

Isaiah said, "This is the rest. This is the refreshing. Hereby He causes the weary to rest." Somehow, with stammering lips and another tongue, as I pray in the Holy Ghost for those hours, my body is offered as a living sacrifice and He purges me from the things that keep me from rest.

Notice when it first started to show up in my life. I was praying long hours out on the riverbed in Oakridge, Oregon. I was so bored praying that I would kick all the green rocks. I would walk along the riverbed looking for green rocks and kick them. Then I started picking red leaves off the trees. I just kept praying hour after hour.

In those days I was inexperienced in it. After about six or seven months went by, I started getting lost in a place in Him. It was incredible.

Long-term pressure on your mind begins to affect it. Doctors say a large percentage of ailments in the body are caused by pressures, worries, cares, torments, and fears. Your body can go haywire. Your mind, submitted to pressure over a long period, begins to break down.

Have you ever had a policeman stop you and ask for your driver's license, then say, "What is your name?" and you sat there and forgot your name?

But I noticed something peaceful beginning to exert an influence on my mind. I kept praying in the Holy Ghost. One time I was watching a religious television program, studying my Bible, and listening to a Kenneth Copeland tape, and I was retaining all of it at the same time.

The more I prayed in the Holy Ghost, the more I entered into that rest and that refreshing.

Through praying the mysteries, you offer your body as a living sacrifice by the power of the Holy Spirit, and purging begins to take place.

What did Jesus say in John 15? If you bear fruit, He will purge you so that you will bear more fruit. Then He went on to say, "Now ye are clean through the word which I have spoken unto you."

The purging process takes place through the Word as transformation happens and the Word comes alive in us.

You cannot pray in the Holy Ghost and speak the mysteries contained within the Word, and then when God starts answering your prayer in the Holy Ghost, the Word of God does not start coming alive in you. It does come alive, and it starts the purging process.

I was gung-ho for prayer. In those early days, I prayed myself to a pretty good place of peace. The first few months of ministry, I found myself sleeping in halls at times, sleeping in my car, and spending so much time in prayer that I did not have time to worry about much.

I came to a certain place of peace, and it was wonderful. Because I had prayed myself to that place, I wanted everybody to have what I had.

I did not understand much about the Word, but I wanted everybody to have what I had. When God started using me somewhat in miracles, people were attracted to the Word of God. They would ask, "What do you do?"

I would say, "I play Kenneth Hagin tapes and Kenneth Copeland tapes, then I spend the day praying in tongues. Then I walk out there, pray for people, and things start happening."

"Is that what you do?"

"Yes."

"How much do you spend in prayer?"

I would tell them, "Sometimes an hour a day, sometimes six hours, sometimes all day, depending on what I am doing. I might pray a week and then miss a week, and then feel condemned about the week I missed. Can He use me this week because I missed a week? I went through all of that."

The first thing I would do was get them a bunch of Hagin tapes, then tell them, "Pray in the Holy Ghost. I do not know what else to tell you."

For the next two, three, four, five years around Oregon, I had a whole bunch of people praying in the Holy Ghost.

The strangest things began to take place.

I thought every person I launched into prayer would walk out a spiritual giant working miracles. But fewer did than did not. If I got ten people who were called to the ministry turned on to prayer, maybe three would continue with it and seven would fall out and choose some other avenue to try to grow in God.

What I could not understand was the way they fell out.

We would all be gung-ho. They would stand up and testify, "I tell you, I have never seen anything like this!" They would make a big testimony one day, and we would all shout about it. Then suddenly they would disappear completely.

The next thing I would hear, they were still preaching all right, but what they were preaching was how fanatical I was about praying in tongues.

Some of them started preaching, "I did what Roberson said. You think my anointing got better? It got worse. I prayed in those tongues, and I can tell you this much: you can pray too much in tongues. My anointing got less, and it messed me up."

They were right. Their anointing did get less. Then they turned on me. For years, it hurt my feelings so badly.

One of my associates broke away. Some people had given us land, and before he would leave, he made me give all the land back. Then came hatred, strife, fights, and preaching about praying too much in tongues and getting weird.

I did not understand why they were dropping out of prayer and getting weird. I knew I had some rough times, but I stuck it out because the Word says if you build yourself up on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Ghost, then by golly, you build yourself up. That is all there is to it. I do not care what my emotions say. If the Word says it, then I choose to believe what the Word says.

Later I was with Rick Renner, and a man came up to the tape table and said, "I want to be a mighty intercessor, but I know this lady who prayed too much in tongues and got weird. What do I do to keep from getting weird?"

I could not take it anymore. I did not even wait on Rick. I stepped up between them and said, "Look, friend, if you get weird, it is because you already had the capacity to be weird."

It made me mad. Because when we turn ourselves over as a living sacrifice, including this key of prayer, what makes us think that everything God wants to purge out of us is something we want to get rid of?

Most of us want God's great anointing. We want our pie, but we want to eat it too. We are saying, "God, leave me alone. Just give me Your glory to bring more glory to what I am doing. If You want to purge me, I will tell You what You can purge. But these areas over here, leave them alone."

I am sorry, my friend, but in the process of offering yourself as a living sacrifice, you are turning yourself over to the Holy Spirit. He is not conforming you to this world. Transformation is taking place so you can find the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God for your personal life.

The Holy Ghost will attempt to purge you not only from the things you want to get rid of, but also from the things you do not want to get rid of.

This is what begins to happen in the basics of prayer.

Jesus said the Word was sown in wayside ground, stony ground, thorny ground, and good ground. In the wayside ground, Satan came immediately and took it away. In stony ground, it took root for a little while, but the roots went outward instead of downward because they hit stones. So the stalk shot up, and when the first wind of persecutions and afflictions came, it was blown over because it was stony ground.

The seed was sown among stones. But I want you to know, the stones were already resident there when the seed was sown.

The thorns were already resident in the ground when the seed was sown into thorny ground. The cares of this life, the deceitfulness of riches, and the lusts of other things sprang up and choked the Word of God. Those seeds were already resident when the Word landed.

Then Jesus talked about good ground. He said these are they sown on good ground who bring forth thirtyfold, sixtyfold, and a hundredfold.

Then He said, "Is the Word given to you not to be understood? Is a candle lit to be hidden under a bushel? There is nothing hidden that shall not be made manifest, neither anything kept secret that shall not come abroad."

He was not saying the ground was predestined to remain that way. He was not saying, "This ground is stony, so it will never have a harvest. This ground is thorny, so it will never have a harvest. Only good ground will have a harvest."

What made the ground good was that the Word was sown as light in the darkness. The Word was meant to reveal what was hidden in darkness so you could purge it out of your life and produce thirtyfold, sixtyfold, and a hundredfold.

But not everything the Holy Spirit wants to purge do we want to get rid of. This is where difficult times come in prayer. And this is still basics.

The first things He purges us from follow that progression: persecutions and afflictions, then the cares of this life, then the deceitfulness of riches, and finally the lusts of other things.

The first thing He purges us from is the Gospel being removed from us by common persecutions and afflictions.

If the people on your job treat you ugly, it does not bother you anymore. Afflictions come. Torments come. Lack comes. People persecute you. But come hell or high water, that stuff is not going to make you backslide anymore.

The first thing praying in the Holy Ghost does for a person is edify him and make him strong enough, excited enough, to serve God no matter how much persecution and affliction the devils bring.

The next step He begins working on is purging you from the slow monotony of the cares of this world.

Hour after hour, you enter into the work. They need laborers in the church. It is vacuuming. It is working. You are used to seeing miracles, healings, services, and hearing messages preached. Then it is time to settle down, and the cares of this life are perched on you. The thorn seeds are growing, and the Word is not as exciting as it used to be.

The Holy Ghost will purge you past the common cares of this world. You will remain excited because you light your own furnace. You do not care if the whole church backslides. You are still going to be up vacuuming the church, working, and praying, because the cares of this life will not choke your ministry, your call, and the Word out of your life.

The next progression is the deceitfulness of riches, and then the lusts of other things.

As long as money has you, you are deceived by it.

Someone says, "I do not really have to worry about that because I do not have any."

More men have been destroyed chasing money than by having it. You say, "I do not have to worry about it because I do not have any." You had better get purged from not having any.

God dealt to every man according to his ability. When He gave you your measure, He did not leave out anything needed for what He called you to do. If He called you to win Mexico for God, then He gave you the faith to win it.

If you go home and stand before God and complain, "I could not do it because I did not have any money," He will say, "You were deceived. Contained within your measure was all the money you ever needed to believe in."

As long as a thorn seed exists on the inside of you that can rise up and choke the Word of God, and as long as money can own you, you cannot receive money from God the way you need to.

You may say, "I really want to."

It does not matter. If money owns you, and you come into a place where everybody is excited about prayer, what you want is to pray and still be owned by money. You want to be a tightwad and still have the glory of God fall on you and use you like crazy.

But when the Holy Ghost performs transformation, He demands every area of your life.

This is what begins to happen to people who fall away.

They get excited when they are purged past persecutions and afflictions. They get excited when the cares of this life can no longer take them out. "Glory to God, I got past all of that!"

But then, after six months, a year, or two years of praying, depending on how deep-seated and how many thorn seeds are sown in their lives, transformation starts taking place. They are no longer being conformed to the world, but transformed by the renewing of the mind.

Pretty soon the Holy Ghost begins to rise up on the inside and exert an influence on the mind, saying, "Who owns you? Are you Mine? Would you please give Me the key to that door you have never allowed Me into?"

And you say, "No, I am not going to give You that key. But I do want to continue praying."

So every day you continue to pray, He approaches your spirit and says, "Would you please give Me the key to that inner sanctuary? Is everything you have Mine? Is your security in Me? Would you please give Me the key?"

You start getting annoyed. It does not come to you as an audible voice. But the emotions, the fear of not having the wealth, the fear around everything you want, and all that emotional fear begins to declare war against your unrenewed mind.

The more you pray, the more emotional you can get, because you cannot continue in prayer without Him continuing to confront you.

You go into prayer feeling pretty good, and when you leave, instead of feeling more anointed, you feel more down. You say, "I thought this was supposed to edify me. I come to church and pray, and I leave feeling worse."

Why? Because something in you does not want to turn loose, and the Holy Spirit is demanding that you turn loose.

So preachers begin to get mad. "This prayer stuff does not work."

No, it works great. You cannot pray in tongues without experiencing transformation as a living sacrifice. But not everything He wants to purge is something you want purged.

Why do we go into prayer feeling up, and then four or five months later say, "Every time I go into prayer, it depresses me"?

The lust of other things is a dilly. Self-exaltation is a dilly. Complacency and indifference are dillies.

It is easy to get purged from persecutions and afflictions. "I do not care if all my relatives like it or not. I am going to church, and I am going to stay saved." That realm is rather easy to make in God.

But those self-exaltation realms are something else. Our gift must become a servant to the Kingdom instead of a vocation. Otherwise we say, "I cannot preach at your church because you have nothing that will exalt my ministry. I can only minister in places where it benefits my call and builds my ministry."

Instead of serving the Kingdom, the ministry becomes self-exaltation.

When the Holy Ghost starts picking on that, you say, "Holy Ghost, why can You not just pray through me and leave me alone?"

All of a sudden, uncontrolled anger starts taking over. You have prayed for six months, and you think, "I come to church and pray, but I feel less edified all the time. I am on edge."

Why? Because you do not want to turn loose of it.

Someone sits in your chair when you come in, and you say, "I could win the whole city through prayer if not for one problem: you will not get out of my chair. Please get out of my exalted chair. I always pray in that chair."

Then you think, "I do not understand it. I have been praying a year, and I am more of an emotional mess than I was before I began to pray."

That is because you were more carnal about the things that were wrong with you than you realized.

When the purging process begins, it is really something.

Some of the strongest things that have been purged out of me these last three years were intimidation and the fear of man. They were blocking me from walking in a higher degree of peace than I had ever walked in before.

That is why I can confidently say, as He is working His plan in my life, I have learned what the purging process is about. When I hit one of those places, it is not time to run. It is time to go into the closet.

Shouldn't you take the hint that your family was the same before you started praying as after you started praying? But after you spend six months in prayer, you walk home, look your family over, and decide they are a bunch of unrighteous outfits who cannot appreciate such a righteous fellow as yourself.

Then you start yelling at them. But they have not changed. It is not something wrong with them. It was something wrong with you.

This one thing I have found out after years: the worse I feel about praying, the more I am accomplishing by doing it.

When my emotions are fighting me so hard, and something inside me does not want to die, and I do not want to go to prayer, and I do not want anybody even to talk to me about prayer, that is not the time to quit.

Not only do I not want to go to prayer, I do not want to want to go to prayer. Do you understand that? "Do not talk to me about it. I do not even want to want to go to prayer."

Then people quit and say, "I would come, but I would not get through. There was no anointing. My emotions went crazy. I did not even want to want to pray."

I have found out that at that stage, when the Holy Spirit is able to pull those character flaws out in front of you in your personal life, it is for personal examination. When they are fighting you so hard emotionally, that is not the time to fall out of prayer.

Even though you do not feel like you are producing anything, and your words feel like they are falling on the floor, and you need a spatula to throw them up to heaven, you are actually producing more than when you are free-flowing.

All the free-flowing did was build you spiritually and edify you up to a place where He could pull out what was wrong with you so He could put it to death. That final death throes is the emotional war.

That is not the time to quit. That is the time to jump in and say, "I am not moved by what I see or feel. I am only moved by what I believe. If this is causing death in me so I can be transformed to the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God, then let us get on with it."

When you stay in, my friend, eventually you will come out the other side, and He will bring you into a degree in God that you have never walked in before, because something that hindered you has been put to death. The rest of your life will be different.

There is more to this than just praying. Not for you there is not, but there will be.

Why go from place to place and live an old mediocre life when you could pass through your generation and make a difference? You do not have to pass through this life with no one ever knowing you were alive.

God wants to purge the things that keep you from fulfilling His absolute perfect will. He will do it if you offer your body as a living sacrifice on the altar He has prepared for it. It is offered by the Holy Spirit as He transforms you to the Word.

He will do it, my friend. You do not have to pass this way and never make a difference.

For seven years I was in and out of praying in the Holy Ghost. I would hit those critical mass times, and sometimes they would take me out of prayer for a long time. Then I would go back in, come up to that place again, and get out of it again. Then I would get in again.

Finally I made it to phase two, and God introduced me to it after a time of fasting. I will never forget it.

I walked into a service, and my banker fell down and could not move for twenty minutes. A night or two later, I tried to reach the prayer line, and people started falling over. One time I was generally praying over the crowd, and people in the crowd started falling down.

I said, "God, You have done something. You have brought me into another phase."

For about a year or two in that phase, I started being asked to camp meetings. I got to speak with men whose old sweaty coats I would have paid hundreds of dollars just to hold in the back room. It was a wonderful phase. I got caught up and had the time of my life.

Then, two or three years into it, something entered my life and attached itself to me. I did not know what it was. Evidently there was something in my life it could attach to: intimidation, fear, torment, and insecurity I had not been able to reach.

I used to get around well-known ministers in the back rooms and fish until they complimented me because of my insecurity.

Something entered my life. What did it feel like? It was a subtle pressure. I have tried to put my finger on it. It increased year after year and became stronger and stronger. The only way I could get relief from this pressure was to not even act like I was going to pray. If I gave up prayer, I was under much less pressure.

The pressure kept pushing me toward watching television all day long so I would not feel it. If I buried myself in television, the pressure would not be there. If I did not pray, the pressure would not be there. If I did not get into the Word and meditate it, the pressure would not be there.

But when I would shake myself and begin to pray, it would wear me back down, and I would quit again.

At the same time, the pressure was increasing and pushing me to do more and more wrong in every area. While I was trying to stand up under this, a voice came and started preaching grace to me. It was probably what people would call ultimate grace.

It said, "Go on. You can do that. After all, He still uses you. Every time you walk out in a camp meeting, the power of God falls. It is all by grace, not by works, lest any man should boast. If you get into works and all that praying, you are trying to take away from the Spirit."

It would preach to me until, when it was finished, I would feel free to do worse and worse. The pressure was off me when I yielded to it.

Whatever that thing was, it had come and attached itself to a thorn seed. Until I killed the thorns, I could not seem to get rid of it. I would run it off for a while, and then it would wear me down again.

I would lie down in a motel and say, "I have a good ministry."

Many of my friends I ministered with at that time, camp meeting speakers, went through the same thing. I know because it was pressuring me to go in the same direction many of them went. I watched many of my friends being destroyed.

The pressure kept increasing on me until I was at the Mile High Conference, preaching for Marilyn and Wally Hickey. God was gracious to me there. I looked at the deaf section and realized I had been at that church every year, one time with Benny Hinn, then another year with the Happy Hunters, then with R. W. Schambach, then with Larry Lea. That deaf section had survived us all.

I woke up and said, "I cannot take this anymore."

When many of my friends went the way of that pressure, it shocked me so badly that instead of going with the pressure anymore, I entered into fasting and praying. The increase of prayer and fasting continued until the thorn seed of intimidation, fear, and worry began to be uprooted.

The more I continued in it, the more it was put to death. After one of those seeking times, I came out with the peace of God, and He said, "This is what you have been looking for, son. This will make you more unmanageable by the devil than anything that has ever come."

That deep-seated peace He embedded on the inside of my spirit changed me.

Yes, there is a realm where revival lives, a tremendous outpouring of the Spirit. The devil is enraged with it. He hates anyone pressing for that realm. He hates anyone who reports for constant prayer and hammers at it until they hit those places, put them behind them, and press on into God.

He hates people who get rid of complacency, crucify the flesh, keep pushing into God, and let God deal with the stones and thorns, lifting them higher and higher until He brings them to a place where He can pour His Holy Ghost out on them the way He wants to.

I can assure you that this peace tells me there is a realm of revival. My God, there is a realm of revival.

Why do we not see a hundred people in wheelchairs lining the church on Sunday? Why do we not see a thousand mothers bringing their deaf and mute children in? Why are they not lining up in the big camp meetings we are having now?

They are not lining up because nothing happened the last time they came.

Let me tell you what the devil is camping on. He loves to pick on your flesh, irritate you, keep you out of prayer, and get you mad at each other over little strife, carpet, and second-rate expendable issues. Pray a little while, and you get mad at each other.

But it is not the person next to you who has the problem. It is you. You are in a critical mass.

The devil likes to keep us at a low level operation of fighting, striving, and staying out of prayer.

"If you pressure me too much, Roberson, I will go somewhere where they require nothing of me."

That is what I did. I ran somewhere where they would assure me I was all right without doing it. But I am at peace now.

That realm of revival is encamped around by principalities and powers. They know that if fifty or a hundred people jump out of wheelchairs, they will have to deal with every relative of those people. They know they will have to deal with hundreds of thousands affected because a thousand deaf and mute children walked out of a meeting talking.

It is not just because they hate the people so much that they block the healing. They block the healing because they cannot afford the revival.

So what do we do? Year after year in complacency, we have good worship, good songs, encourage each other, and go home. We face the devil, but many times we are not conquerors. Often we are so self-centered that we never get past the idea of our own lives receiving from God.

That is good, but what about becoming a living sacrifice?

I think everybody in this room is young in light of when Jesus is going to come back. We may all have about the same amount of time. You do not have to pass through this generation and fail to make a difference.

You say, "But my name is Mary Wallpaper. Nobody pays any attention to me."

Nobody paid any attention to Anna either. She prayed and she prayed. The priest did not even know who she was. But she said, "My eyes have beheld the promise of God." What an honor God bestowed on that woman.

You say your life cannot make a difference? Oh yes, it can.

A missionary found Yonggi Cho in a city dump, living in a cardboard shack, got him healed and born again. How would you like to be responsible for that?

Hallelujah.

Having revival on good ground means such as hear the Word and bring forth thirtyfold, sixtyfold, and a hundredfold.

Is the candle lit so the Word can be hidden under a bushel? No. It is put on a candlestick so that when you walk into the room, every obstacle hidden in darkness is revealed by the light.

That is what the Word is given to you for: to reveal every obstacle in your room that is keeping you from producing a hundredfold.

This is your Sunday Basics of Prayer.